

A Choice That Has a Cost: The Disagreement

有代价的选择：分歧

Theme: 心理、决策、责任与人生选择 · New: 44 · Review: 18 · Planned cumulative progress: 44/6,127

English Story

The disagreement was about **whose** name would stand on the report, and **these** two friends had never argued about anything so **precious**. “**Moreover**, the **architect** is **accountable** to the client,” the director said. “**Furthermore**, a **partial** account is **hazardous** to everyone.” **Hers** was the safer road and **yours** was the braver one.

The **cliff** outside the office was **occasionally** used as a symbol: **safe** ground above, a **dangerous** drop below. “You **shrug** at the risk because it is the **villager** who **dare** not refuse,” the **nephew** of the client said. “That is not **courage**; it is **astonishment** dressed as **bravery**.”

The **heroic** version of the story was also the **tragic** one. “An **inventor** and a **bankrupt** have the same instinct,” the **niece** said, shaking her head. “One is **courageous** and the other is merely **dizzy**.” The **stainless** reputation of the firm was, **likewise**, a **supplement** to the argument rather than a part of it.

The **peculiarity** of the case was that everyone involved was **anxious** about the same thing and nobody would say it. “We are terrified of being **cowardly**,” Maya wrote, “and so we take the riskiest option and call it principle.” The amazing part was how little difference the decision made to the outcome.

The **amazement** in the room turned to grief when the **heroism** of the previous year was examined again. “**Besides**, a young couple's chances are not **yours** to spend,” Lin said. “The value of a value is that it can be considered before the price is paid.”

The compromise was to sign the report together, with the high figure and the low figure on the same page. The stronger claim would appear first, the weaker one second, and the name of whoever disagreed would be printed beside it. **Moreover**, **these** two things are either **risky** or **hazardous**, and everything depends upon **whose** name is on the top. The value and the price are too high for a try, although a **strong** claim can still appear. A **peculiarity** of the case is that a **partial** account is **invariably** more **precious** to the author than to the reader. **Whom** do we believe? The answer must be accepted, and a **terrific** outcome would **grieve** us; a good carry and a bad number are equal in the same ledger.

中文翻译

分歧关乎谁的名字会出现在报告上，而这两位朋友从未为如此珍贵的事争吵过。“而且，建筑师对客户负有责任，”主管说，“此外，一份偏袒的记述对每个人都是危险的。”她那条是更安全的路，你那条是更勇敢的路。

办公室外的悬崖偶尔被当作一个象征：上面是安全的地面，下面是危险的落差。“你对风险耸耸肩，因为不敢拒绝的是村民，”客户的侄子说，“那不是勇气；那是被当成勇敢的惊愕。”

这个故事英勇的版本也是悲剧的版本。“一个发明家和一个破产者有着同样的本能，”侄女摇摇头说，“一个勇敢，另一个只是晕眩。”公司那无瑕疵的名声，同样只是这场论证的一份补充，而不是它的一部分。

这个案子的奇特之处在于，所有相关的人都为同一件事忧虑，却没有人愿意说出来。“我们害怕变得怯懦，”曼雅写道，“于是我们选最冒险的那条路，然后把它叫做原则。”令人惊异的是，这个决定对结果的影响有多小。

当上一年的英雄主义被重新审视时，屋里的惊异变成了悲伤。“再说，一对年轻夫妇的机会不是你该花掉的，”林伟说，“一种价值的价值在于它可以在付出代价之前被考虑。”

妥协的方案是一起签署报告，把高数字和低数字放在同一页上。较强的主张排在前面，较弱的后，而无论谁不同意，他的名字都会印在旁边。而且，这两样东西要么是冒险的，要么是危险的，而一切都取决于顶上是谁的名字。对一次尝试来说，价值和价格都太高，虽然一个强有力的主张仍然可以出现。这个案子的一处奇特之处是：一份偏袒的记述对作者来说，总是比对读者更珍贵。我们该相信谁？答案必须被接受，而一个极好的结果会让我们悲伤；一次漂亮的搬运和一个糟糕的数字，在同一本账簿里是相等的。

Core Vocabulary · 核心词汇

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
these ði:z POS: pron	pron. 这些 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: pron. The plural of this. See This.; pl. of This
whose hu:z POS: pron	pron. 谁的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: pron. The possessive case of who or which. See Who, and Which.
chance tʃæns. tʃɑ:ns POS: n	n. 机会, 意外, 可能性; vi. 偶然发生; vt. 冒险 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a risk involving danger; v. be the case by chance
whom hu:m POS: pron	pron. 谁 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: pron. The objective case of who. See Who.
safe seɪf POS: n	n. 保险箱, 冷藏室; a. 安全的, 可靠的, 平安的, 稳健的, 有把握的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. strongbox where valuables can be safely kept; n. a ventilated or refrigerated cupboard for securing provisi...
dangerous ˈdeɪndʒərəs POS: a	a. 危险的; [法] 危险的, 危害的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. involving or causing danger or risk; liable to hurt or harm; s. causing fear or anxiety by threatening grea...
moreover məˈəʊvə POS: adv	adv. 而且, 此外 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r in addition; furthermore, their quality is improving"; moreover, mice nested there"
yours juəz POS: pron	pron. 你的(东西), 你们的(东西) Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: pron. See the Note under Your.
occasionally əˈkeɪʒənli POS: adv	adv. 有时候, 偶而 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r. now and then or here and there
anxious ˈæŋʃəs POS: a	a. 忧虑的, 发愁的, 渴望的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. eagerly desirous; s. causing or fraught with or showing anxiety
furthermore ˈfɜːðəˈmɔː POS: adv	adv. 此外, 而且 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r. in addition; furthermore, their quality is improving"; moreover, mice nested there"
shrug ʃrʌɡ POS: n	n. 耸肩; v. 耸肩 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a gesture involving the shoulders; v. raise one's shoulders to indicate indifference or resignation
architect ˈɑːkɪtekt POS: n	n. 建筑师, 设计者, 缔造者 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. someone who creates plans to be used in making something (such as buildings)
besides bɪˈsaɪdɪz POS: prep	prep. 除...之外; adv. 而且, 此外 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r. making an additional point; anyway; besides, we can't afford it"; r. in addition
hers heəz POS: pron	pron. 她的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: pron. See the Note under Her, pron.
dare deə POS: n	n. 挑战, 挑动, 大胆; v. 敢, 胆敢 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a challenge to do something dangerous or foolhardy; v. to be courageous enough to try or do something
courage ˈkʌrɪdʒ POS: n	n. 勇气, 胆量 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a quality of spirit that enables you to face danger or pain without showing fear
cliff klɪf POS: n	n. 悬崖, 绝壁 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a steep high face of rock
partial ˈpɑːʃəl POS: a	a. 部分的, 偏袒的, 偏爱的; n. 分音 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. being or affecting only a part; not total; a. showing favoritism
precious ˈpreʃəs POS: a	a. 宝贵的, 珍贵的, 过于精致的, 珍爱的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. of high worth or cost; r. extremely
invariably ɪnˈveəriəbli POS: adv	adv. 不变化地, 恒定地, 始终如一地 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r without variation or change, in every case
terrific teˈrɪfɪk POS: a	a. 非常好的, 极端的, 可怕的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. very great or intense; s. causing extreme terror
tragic ˈtrædʒɪk POS: a	a. 悲惨的, 悲剧的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. very sad; especially involving grief or death or destruction; a. of or relating to or characteristic of tra...

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
supplement 'sʌplɪmənt POS: n	n. 补充物, 增刊, 补充, 补遗, 补编, 附录, 补角; vt. 补充, 增补 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a quantity added (e.g. to make up for a deficiency); v. add as a supplement to what seems insufficient; v. s...
risky 'riski POS: a	a. 危险的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s involving risk or danger; s not financially safe or secure
likewise 'laɪkwaɪz POS: adv	adv. 同样地, 也 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r in like or similar manner; r in addition; r equally
hazardous 'hæzədəs POS: a	a. 危险的, 冒险的, 碰运气的; [法] 危险的, 冒险的, 碰运气的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. involving risk or danger
accountable ə'kauntəbl POS: a	a. 负有责任的, 可说明的, 可解释的; [经] 负有责任的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. liable to account for one's actions
villager 'vɪlɪdʒə POS: n	n. 村民 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. one who has lived in a village most of their life
heroic hɪ'roʊɪk POS: a	a. 英勇的, 英雄式的, 壮丽雄伟的; n. 英雄诗, 史诗, 英勇行为 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. relating to or characteristic of heroes of antiquity; s. having or displaying qualities appropriate for her...
nephew 'nefju: POS: n	n. 侄子, 外甥 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a son of your brother or sister
niece ni:s POS: n	n. 侄女, 甥女 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a daughter of your brother or sister
bankrupt 'bæŋkrʌpt POS: n	n. 破产者; a. 破产的; vt. 使破产 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. someone who has insufficient assets to cover their debts; v. reduce to bankruptcy; s. financially ruined
astonishment ə'stonɪʃmənt POS: n	n. 惊异, 惊愕, 使人惊异的事物 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the feeling that accompanies something extremely surprising
courageous kə'reɪdʒəs POS: a	a. 勇敢的, 大胆的, 有胆量的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a possessing or displaying courage; able to face and deal with danger or fear without flinching
inventor ɪn'ventə POS: n	n. 发明家; [法] 发明人, 发明家, 创造者 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. someone who is the first to think of or make something
stainless 'steɪnlɪs POS: a	a. 无瑕疵的, 不锈钢的; [机] 不锈的, 污染的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. (of reputation) free from blemishes
amazement ə'meɪzmənt POS: n	n. 惊愕, 惊异 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n the feeling that accompanies something extremely surprising
dizzy 'dɪzi POS: a	a. 晕眩的, 眼花缭乱的; vt. 使晕眩 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. make dizzy or giddy; s. having or causing a whirling sensation; liable to falling
grieve gri:v POS: vt	vt. 使悲伤; vi. 悲痛, 伤心 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. feel grief; v. cause to feel sorrow
bravery 'breɪvəri POS: n	n. 勇敢 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n a quality of spirit that enables you to face danger or pain without showing fear; n feeling no fear
heroism 'herəʊɪzəm POS: n	n. 英勇, 勇敢事迹, 豪侠行为 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the qualities of a hero or heroine; exceptional or heroic courage when facing danger (especially in battle)
peculiarity pi.kju:li'ærɪti POS: n	n. 特质, 特性, 怪癖 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an odd or unusual characteristic; n. a distinguishing trait
cowardly 'kaʊədli POS: a	a. 怯懦的, 懦弱的; 胆小的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. lacking courage; ignobly timid and faint-hearted